

Word family: **essential / essentially / essentials / essentiality**

Base word: essential

Part of speech: mainly **adjective**, also **noun**

Related forms:

* **essential** (adj.) — 必要的；不可或缺的；本質上的

* **essential** (n.) — 必需品；必要之物

* **essentials** (plural n.) — 必需品；基本要素

* **essentially** (adv.) — 本質上；基本上；實際上

* **essentiality** (n.) — 必要性；不可或缺性（較正式、較少見）

Useful expressions / extensions:

* **essential for**

* **essential to**

* **essential that**

* **essential part**

* **essential skill**

* **essential information**

* **essential requirement**

* **essential service**

* **essential worker**

* **bare essentials**

* **daily essentials**

* **travel essentials**

* **the essentials of**

* **essentially the same**

* **essentially a question of**

* **essential oil**

* **essential amino acid**

* **essential nutrient**

Meaning in this passage

> Although group work is **essential** in the modern workplace, it often becomes unpopular because of unequal participation...

Here, **essential** means:

absolutely necessary and very important for something to function properly — 必不可少的；不可或缺的

The passage argues that modern workplaces increasingly depend on group work, so teamwork is not merely useful; it is often necessary.

****中文翻譯：****

雖然團隊合作在現代職場中是****不可或缺的 / 必不可少的****，但它往往因為參與不均等問題而變得不受歡迎。

So here:

****essential = 某件事重要到不能缺少，沒有它便很難正常運作或達成目標****

1. ****essential (必要的；不可或缺的) — 必要的；不可或缺的****

This is the exact sense used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> Group work is ****essential**** in the modern workplace.

團隊合作在現代職場中是****不可或缺的****。

Practice 2

> Clear communication is ****essential**** for effective teamwork.

清晰溝通對有效團隊合作來說是****必不可少的****。

Practice 3

> Trust is ****essential**** in any strong team.

信任在任何強大的團隊中都是****不可或缺的****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****essential = extremely important and necessary; something cannot work properly without it****

2. ****essential for something — 對某事來說必不可少****

Practice 1

> Good communication is ****essential for teamwork****.

良好溝通對團隊合作來說是**不可或缺的**。

Practice 2

> Sleep is **essential for good health**.

睡眠對良好健康來說是**必不可少的**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****essential for X = 對 X 的成功、正常運作或存在十分必要****

3. ****essential to something — 對某事不可或缺****

Very close to ****essential for****, but often slightly more structural/formal.

Practice 1

> Trust is ****essential to effective leadership****.

信任對有效領導是**不可或缺的**。

Practice 2

> Cooperation is ****essential to the success of the project****.

合作對項目成功是**至關重要而不可缺少的**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****essential to X = 構成 X 或使 X 成功的一個不可缺少部分****

4. ****it is essential that... —是必要的****

A major formal grammar pattern.

Practice 1

> It is ****essential that every member understands their role****.

每名成員都明白自己的角色是**非常必要的**。

Practice 2

> It is **essential that managers communicate clearly**.

管理人員清楚溝通是**必不可少的**。

MCQ-ready definition:

it is essential that... = 某件事情非常重要並必須做到

5. **essential skill — 必備技能**

Practice 1

> Communication is an **essential skill** in the workplace.

溝通是職場中的一項**必備技能**。

Practice 2

> Time management is an **essential skill** for students.

時間管理是學生的一項**必要技能**。

MCQ-ready definition:

essential skill = 某個角色、工作或活動中非常重要、不能缺少的技能

6. **essential part / element — 必要部分；核心要素**

Practice 1

> Trust is an **essential part of teamwork**.

信任是團隊合作中**不可缺少的一部分**。

Practice 2

> Accountability is an **essential element** of effective collaboration.

問責是有效合作的一個**必要要素**。

MCQ-ready definition:

essential part/element = 某整體中不可缺少的重要組成部分

7. ****essential requirement — 必要條件****

Practice 1

> Good communication is an ****essential requirement**** for the role.

良好溝通是這個職位的一項****必要條件****。

Practice 2

> Reliability is an ****essential requirement**** for this job.

可靠性是這份工作的一項****基本必要條件****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****essential requirement = 必須具備或達到的條件****

8. ****essential information — 必要資訊；關鍵資料****

Practice 1

> The report contains all the ****essential information****.

報告包含所有****必要資料****。

Practice 2

> Make sure everyone receives the ****essential information**** before the meeting.

確保每個人在會議前都收到****關鍵資料****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****essential information = 為理解、決策或行動而必須知道的資訊****

9. ****essential service — 必要服務；基本公共服務****

A major institutional use.

Practice 1

> Hospitals provide **essential services**.

醫院提供**必要服務**。

Practice 2

> Transport can be considered an **essential service** in some contexts.

在某些情況下，交通可被視為**基本必要服務**。

MCQ-ready definition:

essential service = 社會正常運作或基本生活不可缺少的服務

10. **essential worker — 必要服務工作者**

Practice 1

> Nurses and emergency staff are often regarded as **essential workers**.

護士和緊急服務人員通常被視為**必要服務工作者**。

Practice 2

> Many **essential workers** continued working during the emergency.

很多**必要服務工作者**在緊急情況期間仍繼續工作。

MCQ-ready definition:

essential worker = 從事社會基本運作不能輕易中斷之工作的員工

11. **essential (本質上的；最基本的) — 本質的；根本的**

A second major adjective branch.

Here, **essential** does not mean “necessary”; it means:

relating to the basic or fundamental nature of something

Practice 1

> The two approaches are different in detail but similar in their **essential nature**.

兩種方法在細節上不同，但**本質上**相似。

Practice 2

> The **essential character** of the organisation has not changed.

這個機構的**本質特徵**沒有改變。

MCQ-ready definition:

essential = relating to the most basic, fundamental nature of something

12. **essential nature / character** — 本質；根本特性

Practice 1

> We need to understand the **essential nature of the problem**.

我們需要理解問題的**本質**。

Practice 2

> The reform did not alter the **essential character** of the system.

改革沒有改變制度的**根本性質**。

MCQ-ready definition:

essential nature/character = 某物最根本、最核心的性質

13. **essential difference / feature** — 根本差異 / 核心特徵

Practice 1

> There is one **essential difference** between the two systems.

兩個系統之間有一個**根本差異**。

Practice 2

> Flexibility is an **essential feature** of the design.

靈活性是這個設計的**核心特徵**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****essential difference/feature = 最根本、最核心、最能界定性質的差異或特徵****

14. ****essential (noun : 必需品) — 必需品 ; 必要之物****

A major noun sense.

Practice 1

> Food and water are basic ****essentials****.

食物和水是基本****必需品****。

Practice 2

> I packed only the ****essentials****.

我只收拾了****必需品****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****an essential / the essentials = 某人生活、活動或情況中必須有的東西****

15. ****the essentials — 必需品 ; 基本要素****

Practice 1

> Take only the ****essentials****.

只帶****必需品****。

Practice 2

> The course teaches the ****essentials of project management****.

這個課程教授項目管理的****基本要點****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****the essentials = 最重要、最基本、不可缺少的東西或知識****

16. ****daily essentials — 日常必需品****

Practice 1

> The shop sells **daily essentials**.

這間店售賣**日常必需品**。

Practice 2

> People rushed to buy **daily essentials**.

人們趕去購買**生活必需品**。

MCQ-ready definition:

daily essentials = 日常生活中經常需要的基本用品

17. **travel essentials** — 旅行必需品

Practice 1

> I packed my **travel essentials** the night before.

我前一晚收拾好**旅行必需品**。

Practice 2

> This bag contains all my **travel essentials**.

這個袋裝了我所有**旅行必備用品**。

MCQ-ready definition:

travel essentials = 旅行期間最基本、最需要攜帶的物品

18. **bare essentials** — 最基本必需品

Practice 1

> We took only the **bare essentials**.

我們只帶了**最基本的必需品**。

Practice 2

> The room contained only the **bare essentials**.

房間裏只有**最基本的必需設施 / 物品**。

MCQ-ready definition:

bare essentials = 只保留最低限度、絕對必要的東西

19. **the essentials of something** — 某事的基本要點

Practice 1

> The workshop covers the **essentials of teamwork**.

工作坊涵蓋團隊合作的**基本要點**。

Practice 2

> Students learn the **essentials of academic writing**.

學生學習學術寫作的**基本知識**。

MCQ-ready definition:

the essentials of X = 理解或進行 X 所必須知道的最基本部分

20. **essentially** (本質上 ; 基本上) — 本質上 ; 基本上

A major family extension.

Practice 1

> The two proposals are **essentially the same**.

兩個方案**本質上 / 基本上是一樣的**。

Practice 2

> Teamwork is **essentially about cooperation**.

團隊合作**本質上就是合作**。

MCQ-ready definition:

****essentially = looking at the basic truth or most important nature of something****

21. ****essentially the same — 基本上相同****

Practice 1

> Their responsibilities are ****essentially the same****.

他們的職責****基本上相同****。

Practice 2

> The two methods are ****essentially the same****, despite different names.

儘管名稱不同，兩種方法****本質上相同****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****essentially the same = 細節可能有差別，但在最重要方面相同****

22. ****essentially a question / matter of — 本質上是.....的問題****

Practice 1

> This is ****essentially a question of fairness****.

這****本質上是一個公平問題****。

Practice 2

> The disagreement was ****essentially a matter of communication****.

這場分歧****本質上是溝通問題****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****essentially a question/matter of X = 最根本來說，問題的核心是 X****

23. ****essential oil — 精油****

A lexicalized technical/commercial sense.

Important: here **essential** does **not** mean “necessary”.

Practice 1

> Lavender **essential oil** is used in many scented products.

薰衣草**精油**被用於很多香味產品。

Practice 2

> The plant's **essential oil** is extracted from its leaves.

這種植物的**精油**從葉片中提取。

MCQ-ready definition:

essential oil = 從植物提取、帶有其特有香味和揮發成分的濃縮油

24. **essential amino acid** — 必需胺基酸

A major biology/nutrition sense.

Practice 1

> Humans must obtain **essential amino acids** from food.

人類必須從食物中攝取**必需胺基酸**。

Practice 2

> This food contains several **essential amino acids**.

這種食物含有多種**必需胺基酸**。

MCQ-ready definition:

essential amino acid = 人體不能自行製造足夠份量，因此必須從飲食中獲得的胺基酸

25. **essential nutrient** — 必需營養素

Practice 1

> Vitamins are **essential nutrients**.

維他命是**必需營養素**。

Practice 2

> The body needs a range of **essential nutrients**.

身體需要多種**必需營養素**。

MCQ-ready definition:

essential nutrient = 身體正常運作需要，但自身不能充分製造、需要從飲食取得的營養物質

26. **essential fatty acid — 必需脂肪酸**

Practice 1

> Omega-3 includes important **essential fatty acids**.

Omega-3 包含重要的**必需脂肪酸**。

Practice 2

> The body must obtain certain **essential fatty acids** from food.

身體必須從食物中攝取某些**必需脂肪酸**。

MCQ-ready definition:

essential fatty acid = 身體需要但不能自行充分合成，因此須從飲食取得的脂肪酸

Important distinction 1: **essential vs important**

This is the biggest distinction.

important

has a lot of significance or value.

essential

so necessary that you cannot properly do without it.

> Good communication is important.

> 良好溝通很重要。

> Good communication is essential.

> 良好溝通是**不可或缺的**。

So **essential** is stronger.

Important distinction 2: **essential** vs **necessary**

These overlap strongly.

necessary

needed for a particular purpose.

essential

often means absolutely necessary and central.

> A passport is necessary for certain journeys.

> 護照在某些旅程中是必要的。

> Trust is essential to teamwork.

> 信任是團隊合作**不可或缺的**。

Essential often carries stronger emphasis.

Important distinction 3: **essential** vs **vital**

vital

extremely important or necessary, often with strong urgency.

essential

necessary and fundamental.

> vital medical treatment

> 極其重要、可能關乎生命的治療

> essential workplace skill

> 職場必備技能

They overlap, but **vital** often sounds more urgent or emphatic.

Important distinction 4: **essential vs fundamental**

essential

cannot be omitted.

fundamental

forms the basic foundation or principle.

> essential equipment

> 必需設備

> fundamental principle

> 基本原則

Something fundamental is often essential, but the emphasis differs:

* **essential** → necessity

* **fundamental** → foundation

Important distinction 5: **essential vs basic**

basic

simple, introductory, or fundamental.

essential

necessary.

> basic English

> 基礎英語

> essential English vocabulary

> 必要 / 必學英語詞彙

Not every basic thing is essential, and not every essential thing is basic.

Important distinction 6: ****essential for vs essential to****

They often overlap.

****essential for X****

focuses on what X needs.

> Sleep is essential for health.

****essential to X****

often emphasizes being an integral part of X.

> Trust is essential to teamwork.

Both are natural in many contexts.

Important distinction 7: ****essential that + clause****

In formal English:

> It is essential that everyone ****be**** informed.

This subjunctive form is especially common in AmE/formal English.

BrE also commonly allows:

> It is essential that everyone ****is**** informed.

or:

> It is essential for everyone ****to be**** informed.

For learners, the last structure is often safest.

Important distinction 8: ****essential noun vs adjective****

Adjective:

> essential information

> 必要資料

Noun:

> pack the essentials

> 收拾必需品

Do not confuse them.

Important distinction 9: **essentials vs necessities**

essentials

things regarded as most necessary.

necessities

things required for basic living or a particular need.

They overlap strongly:

> daily essentials

> 日常必需品

> basic necessities

> 基本生活必需品

Important distinction 10: **essentially does not usually mean “necessarily”**

essentially

= basically / fundamentally

> The two ideas are essentially the same.

> 兩個想法基本上一樣。

necessarily

= inevitably / as a necessary consequence

> Bigger does not necessarily mean better.

> 更大不一定代表更好。

Very important distinction.

Important distinction 11: **essentially vs basically**

They overlap strongly.

basically

more conversational.

essentially

slightly more formal and often emphasizes fundamental nature.

> Essentially, the problem is poor communication.

> 本質上，問題在於溝通不良。

Important distinction 12: **essential oil is lexicalized**

This does **not** mean:

> an oil that is necessary.

Historically/technically, it refers to the plant's characteristic aromatic “essence”.

So learn:

> essential oil = **精油**

as a fixed term.

Important distinction 13: **essential nutrient is technical**

Here **essential** has a precise biological meaning:

the body needs it but cannot make enough of it itself

So:

> essential nutrient

does not merely mean “a very healthy nutrient”.

Important distinction 14: **essential service**

This usually means:

a service society cannot reasonably function without

not merely:

“a very useful service”

So the word carries a stronger institutional sense of necessity.

Important distinction 15: **essential in your passage**

Here **essential** does not simply mean:

> teamwork is beneficial.

The claim is stronger:

modern workplaces often depend on teamwork to function effectively because complex work requires combined expertise

That is why **essential** is a precise choice.

Family-extension note

Essential has three major modern branches:

1. **necessary / indispensable**

* essential skill

* essential service

* essential for/to

2. **fundamental nature**

- * essential nature
- * essential difference
- * essentially

3. **necessary things**

- * essentials
- * bare essentials
- * daily essentials

And some important lexicalized technical extensions:

4. **biology/nutrition**

- * essential nutrient
- * essential amino acid

5. **plant extracts**

- * essential oil

For your passage, the exact branch is:

essential = necessary to the functioning of the modern workplace

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea	
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essential	必要的；不可或缺的	cannot do without	
essential for X	對 X 必不可少	requirement	
essential to X	對 X 不可或缺	integral necessity	
it is essential that	是必要的	formal necessity	
essential skill	必備技能	necessary ability	
essential part	不可缺少部分	integral component	
essential requirement	必要條件	must-have	
essential information	必要資料	must-know	
essential service	必要服務	societal necessity	
essential worker	必要服務工作者	essential role	
essential nature	本質	fundamental character	
essential feature	核心特徵	defining feature	
an essential	必需品	necessary thing	
the essentials	必需品 / 基本要點	core necessities	

daily essentials	日常必需品	everyday needs	
bare essentials	最基本必需品	minimum necessary	
the essentials of X	X 的基本要點	core knowledge	
essentially	本質上；基本上	fundamentally	
essentially the same	基本上相同	same in core	
essential oil	精油	plant extract	
essential amino acid	必需胺基酸	must obtain externally	
essential nutrient	必需營養素	biologically necessary	

For your original sentence

> Although group work is ****essential**** in the modern workplace, it often becomes unpopular because of unequal participation, poor communication and clashes of personality...

Here:

****essential = 現代職場往往需要依靠團隊合作才能有效處理複雜工作，所以它並非只是有用，而是很多時候不可缺少****

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 雖然團隊合作在現代職場中是****不可或缺的****，但它往往因參與不均、溝通不良和性格衝突而變得不受歡迎。

The cleanest contrast is:

> ****important** = 重要**

> ****necessary** = 必要**

> ****essential** = **重要到不可缺少 / 沒有它便很難正常運作****

> ****fundamental** = 基礎性的、構成根本的**

For this passage, ****essential**** is intentionally strong: teamwork is presented as a ****practical necessity****, not merely a helpful option.